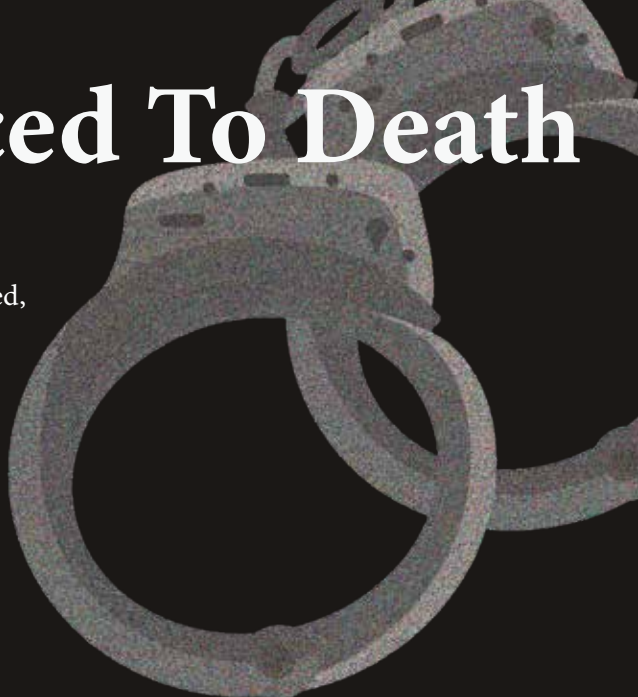
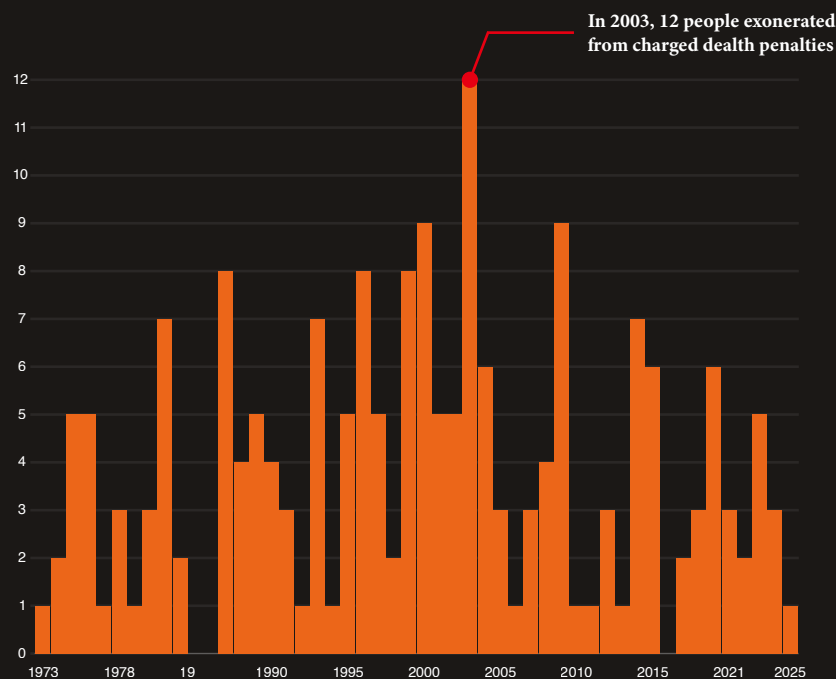


# Wrongfully Sentenced To Death

Exoneration occurs when a person convicted of a crime is later cleared of all charges after new evidence or legal review establishes their innocence. Since 1973, 202 people sentenced to death in the United States have been exonerated, according to the Death Penalty Information Center's Innocence Database.



## Number of Exonerations Per Year



From sentencing to death to exoneration, individuals can spend years in prison before being cleared:



**10.5 years**

Median time in prison



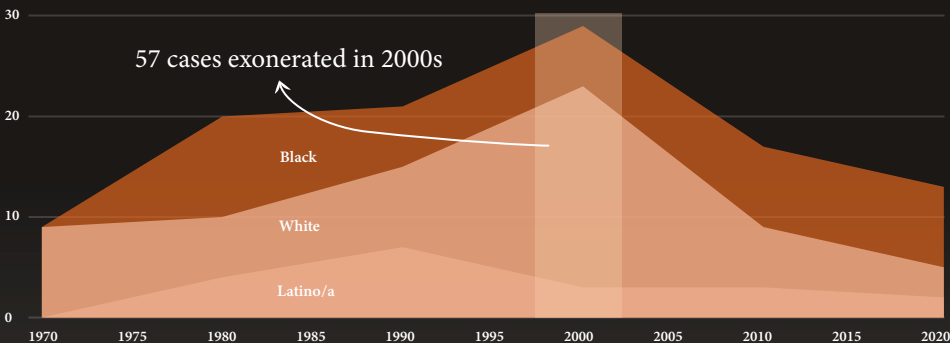
**48 years**

Longest time in prison

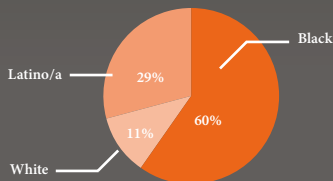
## Death Row Exonerations by Race and Decade

Exonerations of Black defendants account for the largest share across most decades since the 1970s, followed by White and Latino.

American Indian or Alaska Native, Asian, and Other Race categories are not shown because they account for a small number of cases (n=1).



107 cases reportedly involved both most impactful factors, and the majority of those exonerated were people of color.



Source: Death Penalty Information Center | © Jenny Lin

## Contributing Factors in Exonerations

Yes No

Official Misconduct

144 58

Perjury / False Accusation

133 69

False / Misleading Forensic Evidence

64 138

Inadequate Legal Defense

52 150

Mistaken Witness Identification

42 160

DNA Evidence Used in Exoneration

34 168

False Confession

33 169

Insufficient Evidence

20 182

Countes indicate whether each factor was present in the case. Case may include multiple factors.